

How to Use This Appendix

This appendix adds practice exercises, phrase banks, study plans and reference notes aligned with the main guide. Work through one section per study session and review your notes weekly.

Extended Study Material

The following sections were prepared by Mubashir Mehdi for LifeWithBooks to supplement this guide with additional explanations, examples and practice. Work through them after reading the main chapters.

The Proven Left-Right Format

English Vocabulary in Use Upper-Intermediate is part of the bestselling vocabulary series from Cambridge University Press. It follows the proven two-page unit format: the left page presents and explains new vocabulary with definitions, examples and usage notes, while the right page provides exercises for immediate practice. This design makes it perfect for focused 20-30 minute study sessions.

100 Units Covering Essential Topics

The book contains 100 units organized into thematic and linguistic groups. Early units cover word formation (prefixes, suffixes, compounding, conversion), collocations, phrasal verbs and idiomatic expressions. Later units tackle topic-based vocabulary for work and employment, education, science and technology, the environment, media and communication, travel, health, crime and the law, politics, feelings and relationships. Each unit teaches approximately 25-30 new vocabulary items in context, totalling around 3,000 words and expressions across the book. Items are carefully selected based on frequency data and relevance to upper-intermediate learners preparing for exams like Cambridge FCE or IELTS.

Self-Study With Full Answer Key

A complete answer key at the back allows independent learners to check their work immediately. A comprehensive word list and index makes it easy to find where any word is taught. The book works equally well as a classroom resource or a self-study reference, and many teachers assign individual units as targeted homework.

Topic Vocabulary Sets

1. achievement, accomplish, milestone, setback, perseverance
2. ambiguous, clarify, precise, vague, interpret
3. benefit, drawback, advantage, trade-off, consequence
4. collaborate, coordinate, delegate, contribute, facilitate
5. diverse, homogeneous, inclusive, representative, demographic
6. emphasize, highlight, understate, exaggerate, convey

7. feasible, viable, impractical, realistic, ambitious
8. genuine, authentic, artificial, sincere, deceptive
9. hypothesis, evidence, conclude, assume, verify
10. implement, execute, postpone, initiate, abandon
11. justify, rationalize, defend, criticize, acknowledge
12. keen, enthusiastic, reluctant, indifferent, passionate
13. legitimate, valid, questionable, lawful, ethical
14. moderate, extreme, gradual, sudden, substantial
15. notion, concept, perception, misconception, insight
16. objective, subjective, impartial, biased, neutral
17. persistent, consistent, sporadic, intermittent, steady
18. qualify, meet requirements, eligible, exempt, comply
19. reluctant, willing, eager, hesitant, determined
20. significant, negligible, minor, major, noteworthy

Collocation Practice

Match the verb to the natural noun partner:

make - a decision, progress, a mistake, an effort

do - homework, research, your best, damage

take - a break, responsibility, notes, action

have - a meeting, an impact, fun, difficulty

give - advice, a presentation, permission, feedback

pay - attention, a compliment, the bill, a visit

keep - a promise, calm, records, in touch

break - a habit, the news, a record, the law

Extended Reading Passage

Read aloud once for gist, then again for vocabulary. Underline five new words and write your own summary paragraph.

Effective language learning depends on consistent exposure and active use. Many learners spend years studying grammar rules without speaking regularly, which creates a gap between knowledge and performance. Research suggests that daily contact with meaningful input - podcasts, articles, conversations, films with subtitles - builds the mental patterns needed for fluent speech. Output matters too: writing short paragraphs, recording yourself, and joining discussions force your brain to retrieve vocabulary under time pressure, which strengthens long-term memory.

Another key factor is error tolerance. Advanced speakers make mistakes; the goal is communication, not perfection. Keep a personal error log: note recurring problems (prepositions, articles, word order) and review them weekly. Pair study with real tasks - emails, presentations, travel - so new language serves a purpose. Finally, set measurable goals: learn twenty collocations this month, hold a ten-minute conversation twice a week, or finish one graded reader. Small, steady progress beats occasional marathon sessions.

Error Correction Exercises

Find and fix the mistake in each sentence. Answers are in parentheses.

1. She don't like spicy food. (doesn't)
2. I have been to Paris last year. (went - specific past time)
3. He is more taller than his brother. (taller - remove more)
4. We discussed about the problem. (discussed the - no about)
5. She suggested me to apply. (suggested that I apply)
6. I am agree with you. (I agree)
7. He explained me the rules. (explained the rules to me)
8. The informations are useful. (information - uncountable)
9. I look forward to meet you. (to meeting)
10. She is married with a lawyer. (married to)
11. I have a news for you. (some news - uncountable)
12. He did a mistake. (made a mistake)
13. We must to finish today. (must finish)
14. She is boring of the lecture. (bored by / bored with)
15. I am here since three hours. (have been here for)
16. He said that he will come. (would come - reported speech)
17. The children is playing outside. (children are)
18. I am used to wake up early. (used to waking up)
19. She is responsible of the team. (responsible for)
20. We need discuss this later. (need to discuss)

Sentence Building Practice

Combine the prompts into full sentences. Example: [weather / bad / stay home]
 -> Because the weather was bad, we decided to stay home.

1. [deadline / tight / work / weekend]
2. [not familiar / software / ask / colleague]
3. [train / delayed / arrive / late]
4. [research / shows / exercise / improves / memory]
5. [although / tired / finish / assignment]
6. [if / more time / learn / second language]
7. [manager / praised / team / hard work]
8. [before / presentation / rehearse / twice]
9. [customer / complained / slow / service]
10. [since / moved / city / made / friends]
11. [unless / study / regularly / forget / vocabulary]
12. [despite / rain / match / continued]
13. [recommend / book / anyone / interested / history]
14. [while / waiting / bus / read / article]
15. [as soon as / hear / news / call / me]

Four-Week Study Plan

Use this plan to study English Vocabulary in Use - Upper Intermediate in daily 30-45 minute sessions.

Week 1 - Foundations

Days 1-2: Skim the guide and list unknown words. Days 3-4: Study one core chapter and summarize it in your own words. Days 5-7: Do practice exercises aloud; record yourself if possible.

Week 2 - Active Practice

Days 8-10: Focus on your weakest section; redo examples without looking. Days 11-12: Explain the material to a friend or aloud alone. Days 13-14: Mixed review from all sections.

Week 3 - Real Usage

Days 15-17: Use new language in real tasks. Days 18-19: Read or listen to authentic English on the same topic. Days 20-21: Write 300 words applying what you learned.

Week 4 - Consolidation

Days 22-24: Timed practice under exam or workplace conditions. Days 25-26: Fix weak areas using notes and answer keys. Days 27-28: Final review before moving to advanced material.

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